Countries are behind on money to protect nature

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Nearly 200 countries promised to raise lots of money to protect oceans, forests, rivers and **wildlife**. So far, they have raised much less than they planned.

They will talk about this at a big **United Nations** meeting called COP17. It begins Monday in Yerevan, Armenia, and ends October 30. The meeting is about **biodiversity**, which means all the different kinds of plants and animals on Earth. The United States is not part of this **treaty**.

The countries promised $200 billion a year for nature by 2030. Each year from 2023 to 2025, they raised between $75 billion and $92 billion. That is less than half.

"We're not moving fast enough," said Astrid Schomaker, who leads the **treaty**'s office.

There is some good news. The Philippines made an ocean area where people may not catch rays and sharks. Argentina made a new national park. Groups also plan to spend $500 million to help save **threatened species**.

Word Treasure

wildlife -- Wildlife means wild animals and plants that live in nature.

United Nations -- The United Nations is a group of almost every country that works together on world problems.

biodiversity -- Biodiversity means all the different kinds of plants and animals on Earth.

treaty -- A treaty is an official agreement between countries.

threatened species -- Threatened species are kinds of animals or plants that are in danger of disappearing.

Background you need

Biodiversity means all the different living things on Earth, and nature gives people food, clean water and air.

Many countries signed a United Nations treaty that promises to protect nature, and they meet to check how they are doing.

Protecting nature costs money for things like parks, scientists and rangers.

Break it down

WHO: Nearly 200 countries in a United Nations treaty, and Astrid Schomaker, who leads the treaty's office

WHAT: Countries have raised much less money to protect nature than they promised

WHERE: A United Nations meeting called COP17 in Yerevan, Armenia

WHY: Protecting oceans, forests, rivers and wildlife needs money, and countries are behind

Why it matters

The animals and plants you see outside, and the clean water and air you need, depend on people protecting nature.

Test what you remember

1. What is the big United Nations meeting called?

- (A) Earth Day
- (B) Nature Week
- (C) UN100
- (D) COP17

2. Where does the meeting take place?

- (A) New York
- (B) Yerevan, Armenia
- (C) Paris, France
- (D) Manila

3. What does biodiversity mean?

- (A) A type of ocean
- (B) A new country
- (C) A kind of money
- (D) All the different kinds of plants and animals on Earth

4. How much money did countries promise each year by 2030?

- (A) $200 billion
- (B) $500 million
- (C) $92 billion
- (D) $75 billion

5. What did the Philippines do?

- (A) Made an ocean area where people may not catch rays and sharks
- (B) Raised $200 billion
- (C) Left the treaty
- (D) Built a new city

6. Who said "We're not moving fast enough"?

- (A) A shark scientist
- (B) The president of Argentina
- (C) Astrid Schomaker
- (D) No one

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: D 4: A 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Astrid Schomaker: Says countries are not moving fast enough to protect nature.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):